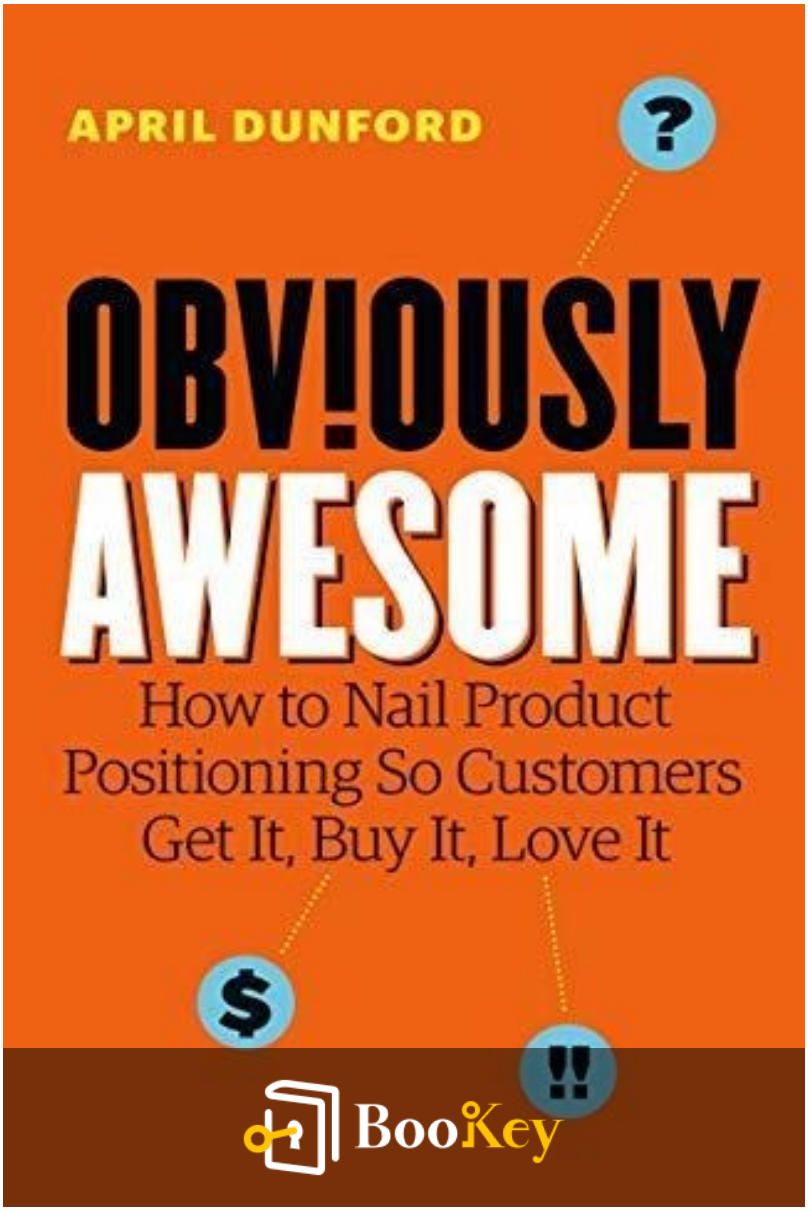
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April Dunford



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Obviously Awesome

Unlocking Your Product's Unique Appeal to Captivate Customers.

Written by Bookey

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About the book

Unleash the full potential of your product with "Obviously Awesome" by April Dunford, a transformative guide to mastering the art of positioning. If you've ever wondered why your incredible product isn't resonating with consumers, Dunford's expertise as a tech executive and successful startup leader will illuminate your path. This insightful book reveals how to identify your product's unique "secret sauce" and effectively communicate its value to the right audience. Packed with engaging anecdotes and real-world case studies, Dunford offers invaluable strategies on the five essential elements of effective positioning, instant audience connection, selecting optimal markets, utilizing various positioning styles, and leveraging market trends. Whether you're an entrepreneur, marketer, or salesperson aiming to capture the market's attention, "Obviously Awesome" equips you with the tools to reveal your product's true awesomeness—and help your customers recognize it too.

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About the author

April Dunford is a recognized expert in positioning and marketing strategy, with over two decades of experience helping tech startups and established companies alike craft compelling narratives around their products. As a sought-after speaker and consultant, she has guided numerous organizations in refining their value propositions to resonate with target audiences, enabling them to gain a competitive edge in crowded markets. Dunford is also known for her engaging and insightful approach to complex marketing principles, making her a respected voice in the field. Her book, "Obviously Awesome," distills her extensive knowledge into actionable strategies for product positioning, empowering businesses to clearly articulate their unique value and drive growth.

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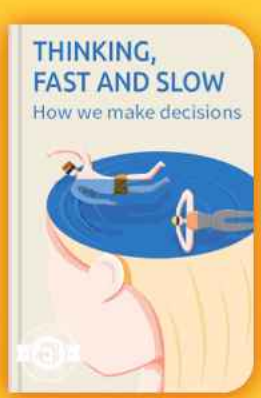
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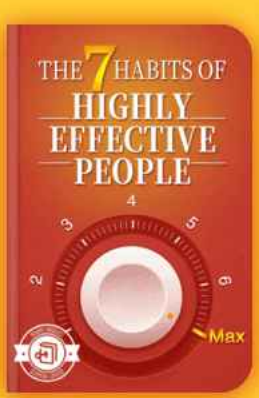
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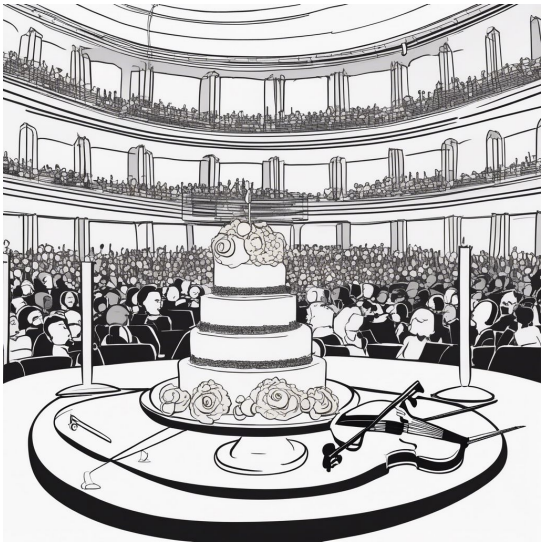
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Chapter 1 Summary : Positioning as Context



POSITIONING AS CONTEXT

Understanding Context in Positioning

Positioning a product is akin to setting the context in a movie's opening scene, which helps viewers understand critical elements such as characters and the nature of the story. For instance, the transition in "Apocalypse Now" showcases how context shifts perceptions. Just as the opening scene prepares viewers for the narrative, proper positioning helps customers grasp the product's purpose.

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The Impact of Context on Perception

When people encounter a new product, they look for contextual clues to determine its significance. An example of this is Joshua Bell, a renowned violinist, who played in a subway but was unrecognized due to the unsophisticated setting. His music, typically valued in a concert hall, was misunderstood without the right context, highlighting how even exceptional products can fail without proper positioning.

Creating Context for New Products

Innovative products often lack recognizable frames of reference, requiring new descriptors to establish their value. Understanding context also involves recognizing the effects of product positioning on business outcomes; products can be framed in various ways that can significantly alter market perception. Effective positioning transforms ordinary offerings into exceptional ones.

The Two Traps in Positioning

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1.

Default Positioning Trap:

Creators might limit their product to a single, self-defined category, overlooking alternative framing that could highlight its true value.

2.

Market Change Trap:

Products can become poorly positioned due to shifts in market dynamics, even if the product itself has not changed.

Examples of Positioning Changes

A baker may create a product perceived as a cake, resulting in specific targeting and competition dynamics. However, if the created item resembles a muffin more closely, the positioning should reflect that transformation, drastically altering the target market and sales strategies.

Deliberate Positioning vs. Default Positioning

The example of the baker attempting to promote a "cake on a stick" illustrates how default positioning can misrepresent the product. By reframing it as a "cake pop," the product appeals to a different consumer context, highlighting its unique

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features correctly.

Repositioning Case Study: Database to Data Warehouse

A startup struggled with its database product until it realized it functioned better as a data warehouse. This repositioning changed perceptions and boosted customer engagement and sales, reflecting the vital need to evaluate the right context for products.

Importance of Effective Positioning

Proper positioning is crucial as it affects customer understanding and potential sales. The lack of a standardized methodology for positioning highlights the need for systematic evaluation of customer perspectives, alternative solutions, and market contexts to ensure unique value delivery.

Next Steps in Positioning

To effectively position products, it is essential to analyze components systematically, focusing on customer perception,

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unique solutions, and relevant contexts that make the product's value clear to its intended audience.

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Example

Key Point:Create the right context for positioning to elevate perceptions of your offerings.

Example:Imagine you're launching a revolutionary kitchen gadget designed to simplify meal prep. If you merely label it as a ‘chopper,’ potential customers might overlook its innovative features. Instead, you frame it as a ‘culinary assistant’ that saves time and enhances cooking enjoyment. By doing this, you're not just selling a product; you're offering a solution that resonates with busy home cooks seeking convenience. This framing allows prospective buyers to quickly understand its value in their lives, transforming how they perceive and ultimately desire your product.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Understanding context is essential for effective product positioning.

Critical Interpretation:April Dunford asserts that the right context is crucial for positioning products effectively, akin to how opening scenes in films define viewer expectations and set the narrative. However, while this perspective emphasizes the significance of framing a product to highlight its unique value, it disregards the potential for inherent product qualities to shine through without extensive context. For example, products like Coca-Cola became iconic largely due to brand strength rather than contextual positioning. Critics may argue that context is overstated and that optimal product quality and consumer experience can sometimes transcend presentation. This idea can be supported by research into consumer behavior, such as the work found in "Thinking, Fast and Slow" by Daniel Kahneman, which suggests that perceptions are shaped not only by context but also by deeper cognitive biases.

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Chapter 2 Summary : The Five (plus One) Components of Effective Positioning



Section	Summary
Introduction	Positioning in marketing is often misunderstood; this chapter explores key components for effective positioning beyond traditional methods.
Why You Should Never Create a Positioning Statement	Traditional positioning statements are simplistic and ineffective for discerning market advantages or understanding customer perceptions.
Five (Plus One) Components of Effective Positioning	The five components plus one bonus for effective positioning are:
1. Competitive Alternatives	Identify alternatives customers might choose if your solution didn't exist to assess market position.
2. Unique Attributes	Define the unique features that differentiate your offering from competitors.
3. Value (and Proof)	Articulate the benefits of unique attributes, backed by facts and customer feedback for credibility.
4. Target Market Characteristics	Identify customer segments that are most likely to value your product based on demographics or behaviors.
5. Market Category	Define the market category for your product to help customers relate it to existing knowledge.
6. (Bonus) Relevant Trends	Leverage current trends that resonate with your target market to enhance urgency and context for your product.
Interconnections Between Components	The components are interrelated, helping to establish differentiation, identify target customers, and enhance positioning relevance.
Conclusion and Next Steps	Utilizing these components leads to better market positioning; the next chapter will introduce a 10-Step Positioning Process.

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THE FIVE (PLUS ONE) COMPONENTS OF EFFECTIVE POSITIONING

Introduction

Positioning in marketing is often misunderstood and poorly executed. This chapter explores key components of effective positioning, moving beyond the traditional positioning statement approach that fails to provide meaningful insights.

Why You Should Never Create a Positioning Statement

Traditional positioning statements are simplistic templates that do not serve as effective tools for discerning market advantages or developing strategic positioning. They often do not reflect actual customer perceptions or unique value propositions.

Five (Plus One) Components of Effective Positioning

To create effective positioning, one should focus on the

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following five components, plus a bonus:

1.

Competitive Alternatives

- Identify what customers would opt for if your solution didn't exist. Understanding their existing choices is crucial for assessing your own market position.

2.

Unique Attributes

- Define the unique features of your offering that the competition lacks. These can be technical features or specific business models that differentiate your offering.

3.

Value (and Proof)

- Articulate the benefits your unique attributes provide to customers. These claims must be backed by facts and customer feedback to strengthen credibility.

4.

Target Market Characteristics

- Determine which customer segments are most likely to value your product. This includes identifying specific

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demographics or behaviors that align with your offering's strengths.

5.

Market Category

- Define the market category within which your product is positioned. A well-chosen market category helps customers make sense of your offering and relate it to their existing knowledge.

6.

(Bonus) Relevant Trends

- Leverage current trends that resonate with your target market to highlight the importance of your product. Trends can create urgency and context for potential buyers.

Interconnections Between Components

The components of positioning are interconnected. For instance, your unique attributes must be compared against competitive alternatives to establish genuine differentiation. The value derived from these attributes helps identify ideal target customers and shapes your chosen market category. Trending topics can further enhance the relevance of your

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positioning.

Conclusion and Next Steps

Understanding and utilizing these components effectively leads to a better market position. The next chapter will delve into a structured 10-Step Positioning Process designed to implement these concepts in practice.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Rethinking Traditional Positioning Statements

Critical Interpretation:While April Dunford critiques traditional positioning statements for their lack of depth and effectiveness, it is essential to recognize that these templates can still provide foundational guidance for some organizations. Not all businesses have the resources or expertise to delve into the nuanced components Dunford proposes, which may render her viewpoint somewhat elitist. Moreover, studies in marketing underscore that simplified frameworks can aid initial strategic conversations, especially in startups where speed is crucial. Therefore, though Dunford presents a compelling argument for complex positioning strategies, her one-size-fits-all dismissal of positioning statements overlooks their potential utility in specific contexts (Kotler & Keller, 2016).

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Chapter 3 Summary : Step 1. Understand the Customers Who Love Your Product

STEP 1. Understand the Customers Who Love Your Product

In developing a systematic approach to positioning, understanding the interdependencies within the components is vital. The best market category hinges on knowing the target customers and the specific value offered. To determine this, one must assess differentiators and alternatives, as the market category informs customer perceptions of competitors.

A conversation with a fellow marketer illuminated the importance of identifying the happiest customers to uncover effective strategies. By analyzing the traits and reasons behind their satisfaction, businesses can better understand their value proposition and target audience. A successful repositioning often involves creating a shortlist of best-fit customers who quickly appreciate the product and become enthusiastic promoters.

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Identifying Patterns Among Happy Customers

For companies without a base of ecstatic customers, it is suggested to test the product across a diverse audience. This experimentation can reveal insights into customer demographics and preferences. Initial observations about the product's appeal should remain broad to allow flexibility in understanding what resonates with potential customers.

Focusing on Customer Needs Over Product Features

It’s a common inclination to center positioning around the product and its features, but this is often misleading. Customers tend to be more concerned with how a solution meets their immediate needs rather than how it compares to other offerings. Positioning should reflect customer references rather than focusing on investor expectations or

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Chapter 4 Summary : Step 2. Form a Positioning Team

STEP 2. Form a Positioning Team

A successful positioning process requires teamwork across various functions within the company, including sales, marketing, and customer success. Different teams provide unique insights into how customers perceive and experience the product, helping to align all assumptions and ideas through a positioning exercise.

Who Should Be Involved?

The business leader responsible for the product must lead the positioning effort to ensure it is adopted across the organization. In startups, this is typically the CEO or founders, while in larger companies, it may be division or business unit leaders or heads of marketing and product. Marketing is often the first to address weak positioning, but it should not solely "own" the positioning strategy, as it impacts the entire organization. The outputs of positioning

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affect every department, including:

-
Marketing:
messaging, audience targeting, campaign development

-
Sales and Business Development:
customer segmentation, account strategy

-
Customer Success:
onboarding, account expansion

-
Product and Development:
roadmaps, prioritization

Engagement from All Groups

Active participation from leaders of each business function is essential for developing and executing an effective positioning strategy. Each group offers different perspectives on competitive alternatives, unique features, and ideal customer characteristics.

Balancing Participation

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While it is valuable to have representation from various functions, it's important not to overwhelm the discussion with too many participants. Ideally, one or two senior individuals from each group should suffice, with discussions typically effective with three to twelve participants.

Facilitating the Discussion

Bringing in an experienced external facilitator can enhance the positioning discussion’s productivity and balance. An outside perspective helps ensure that all voices are heard and can challenge established assumptions, making the positioning workshop more effective.

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Chapter 5 Summary : Step 3. Align Your Positioning Vocabulary and Let Go of Your Positioning Baggage

STEP 3: Align Your Positioning Vocabulary and Let Go of Your Positioning Baggage

To explore new ways of thinking about a product, it is crucial to set aside old perspectives and establish a common vocabulary around positioning. This involves:
- Ensuring the team shares a clear understanding of:
  - The meaning and importance of positioning.
  - The components that define a position.
  - How market maturity and competitive landscape influence positioning choices.

Letting Go of Positioning Baggage

The objective of the 10-Step Positioning Process is to identify the most effective product position in a market where it can excel. Often, products are perceived through a narrow lens due to historical context, making it challenging

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to envision alternative uses or markets. A notable example is Arm & Hammer baking soda, which successfully transitioned from baking aid to odor eliminator by recognizing its other valuable features.
To facilitate this shift in thinking, the positioning team must acknowledge "positioning baggage," understanding that their historical perspectives may not align with customers' new and fresh interpretations of the product. Acknowledging this disconnect is essential for openness to new ideas.

Positioning Story: Clearpath Robotics Transitioning to Autonomous Vehicles

Clearpath Robotics began by addressing robotics research challenges but evolved to provide intelligent mobile robots for industrial applications. Initially, their perception as simple "robots" limited their appeal against traditional, stationary competitors. Recognizing the unique capabilities of their products, they redefined their offering as self-driving vehicles for industrial use, creating a new division called OTTO Motors. This strategic repositioning, including design changes and targeted marketing, led to accelerated sales, increased investor interest, and industry recognition.

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Example

Key Point:Understanding positioning requires a fresh perspective and shared vocabulary among team members.

Example:Imagine you're part of a marketing team stuck in a routine of promoting an outdated product line without considering its broader potential. To truly harness your product's value, you gather your team in a brainstorming session, encouraging everyone to contribute their thoughts on how the product could be viewed differently. As you dismantle old notions, you begin to realize that the product, initially known for one function, can be an innovative solution in a completely new market. This collective effort of aligning your team's vocabulary around the product's positioning opens the door to fresh ideas, pushing everyone to let go of the limiting 'positioning baggage' that has clouded your vision.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:Evaluate the Need for Flexibility in Positioning Strategies

Critical Interpretation:While April Dunford emphasizes the importance of adopting a common vocabulary and setting aside historical baggage in product positioning, it's crucial to consider that such an approach may overlook the value of a company's established brand narrative. Relying heavily on the notion of 'positioning baggage' can lead to the discarding of valuable market insights gained over time. Critics of Dunford's methodology may argue, as supported by sources like Harvard Business Review, that a brand's history can be a significant asset that informs consumer trust and loyalty. Thus, while embracing new interpretations can foster innovation, it is equally important to strike a balance between historical context and new perspectives to effectively navigate market dynamics.

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Chapter 6 Summary : Step 4. List Your True Competitive Alternatives

STEP 4: List Your True Competitive Alternatives

Understanding Customer Perception

Customers may not view competitors the same way businesses do. Their perspective is crucial for effective positioning. Instead of focusing solely on a product's features, it's important to consider how customers perceive these features relative to alternatives.

Identifying Customer Problems

The core of positioning revolves around the problems customers aim to solve. It is helpful to ask customers directly about their challenges. However, customers may struggle to articulate these issues clearly.

Customer Insights Example

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An example from a startup illustrates that while users spoke technically about their needs, their alternatives to the product (like business intelligence tools or data warehouses) revealed more about their perception than their direct answers about problems.

Realizing Competitive Alternatives

To clarify true competitive alternatives, one should ask: "What would our best customers do if we didn’t exist?" Often, the answer may not be another product but rather manual or simplistic methods like pen and paper.

Conducting the Exercise

When listing alternatives, teams should focus on their best-fit customers and rank them from most common to least

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Chapter 7 Summary : Step 5. Isolate Your Unique Attributes or Features

STEP 5: Isolate Your Unique Attributes or Features

Overview of Unique Positioning

Strong positioning revolves around the strengths of a product. After identifying your competitive alternatives, it’s essential to pinpoint what distinguishes your product as better and different.

Defining Features

Features, or attributes, refer to the specific capabilities of your product or company, such as “a 15-megapixel camera” or “integrates with QuickBooks.” Focus on listing all unique capabilities, even those perceived negatively by some.

Gathering Feedback

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Consider customer feedback when determining your unique attributes. You might possess a rare combination of skills, technology, or sourcing practices that set your business apart.

Understanding Perspectives on Features

Attributes may be viewed differently by team members. An example is a feature that requires professional services for installation—while some see it as a disadvantage, others might view it as a positive offering for customized service.

Proving Your Strengths

To validate your strengths, focus on objective, provable facts rather than subjective opinions. Metrics such as staffing levels, certifications, or speed of proficiency can substantiate claims.

Utilizing Third-party Validation

Evidence from independent reviewers or customer testimonials can enhance your claims about your product's features versus competitors.

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Broadening Your Unique Attributes

Think creatively about what makes your offering unique—this could include proprietary processes, specialized expertise, or unique distribution channels.

Types of Attributes to Consider

Focus on “consideration” attributes that matter during purchasing decisions rather than "retention" attributes, which might only affect renewals. Customers need to first see value to consider buying; otherwise, retention attributes become irrelevant.

Listing Attributes

During this stage, you should compile a comprehensive list of attributes without filtering their importance initially. Grouping will happen in later stages of the process.

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Example

Key Point:Identifying Your Unique Features

Example:When crafting your unique market positioning, imagine you've just launched a cutting-edge app. Start by listing every feature it offers, like real-time collaboration, offline access, or seamless integration with popular software. Consider how potential users might perceive these features differently; for some, the offline mode may seem unnecessary, while others may view it as a lifesaver during travel. Gather feedback from early users to see which attributes resonate most and highlight them in your marketing—this ensures that your distinct advantages are not just known, but truly understood by your target audience as what sets you apart in a crowded marketplace.

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Chapter 8 Summary : Step 6. Map the Attributes to Value “Themes”

STEP 6: Map the Attributes to Value Themes

In this step, we focus on translating product attributes into meaningful value for customers. While attributes such as "15-megapixel camera" or "all-metal construction" signify features, customers ultimately care about the benefits these features provide, like "sharper images" or "a stronger frame."

Moving from Features to Benefits to Value

Articulating value means contextualizing benefits within the goals customers aim to achieve. For example, features lead to benefits, which then translate to values like "sharp photos even when printed" or “cost savings on frame replacements.”

Every feature can yield multiple value points, and we will explore this further in Step 7 to identify customer segments interested in these values.

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Examples of Features, Benefits, and Value

-

Feature:
15-megapixel camera

Benefit:
Sharp photo images

Value:
Images remain sharp when zoomed or printed large.

-

Feature:
All-metal construction

Benefit:
Stronger frame resistant to damage

Value:
Lasts five times longer, saving $50,000 annually on replacements.

-

Feature:
One-click reports

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Benefit:

Fast, easy report generation

Value:

Enables better decision-making across the organization with accurate metrics.

-

Feature:

24-hour support

Benefit:

Always available assistance

Value:

Global operations can receive help across all time zones.

Confusion Between Features and Value

Many people, particularly in technical fields, struggle to separate features from benefits and value. It is crucial to articulate why features matter. For instance, mentioning a "patented fuzzy logic algorithm" needs to be coupled with the benefit of "faster response times," which can lead to

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improved customer satisfaction by enabling immediate responses.

Clustering the Value into Themes

Next, identify recurring themes by grouping related value points from a customer perspective. For example, features like “works on any mobile device” and “works without internet” can collectively support remote operations. Aim to reduce these to one to four value clusters, noting that sometimes only one central value point may emerge.

Conclusion

This positioning exercise prioritizes the most significant features that distinguish a product and presents its unique value clearly, rather than listing every attribute that customers may appreciate. In essence, “The stone age didn’t end because they ran out of stones.”

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Chapter 9 Summary : Step 7. Determine Who Cares a Lot

STEP 7: Determine Who Cares a Lot

Once you've identified the value of your product, focus on understanding which customers prioritize that value. Not all customers appreciate your product's features equally; for example, integration with QuickBooks is crucial for businesses that send numerous invoices but irrelevant to those who do not use QuickBooks.

Segmentation Exercise

Marketers refer to this process as segmentation. However, traditional demographic-based segmentation often fails in the business context. Instead, you should create actionable segmentation based on identifiable characteristics that resonate with your product's value. For consumers, this might include brand preferences, purchasing habits, or personal interests; for businesses, it could involve their sales strategies or product investments.

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Identifying Best-Fit Prospects

Best-fit customers are those who are most excited about your offerings, making them easier to sell to and retain. Contrary to the belief that targeting a broad audience is more effective, focusing on best-fit customers leads to better engagement and sales. They understand and appreciate your product quickly, often valuing it enough to suggest higher pricing.

Narrow Targeting for Success

To optimize limited marketing resources, narrow your target initially, aligning it with your immediate sales goals. Adjust your definition of "best-fit" only if your sales targets cannot be met. Your positioning should resonate with current best-fit customers but remain flexible to evolve with them over time.

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The Concept

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Chapter 10 Summary : Step 8. Find a Market Frame of Reference That Puts Your Strengths at the Center and Determine How to Position in It

Section	Summary
STEP 8: Find a Market Frame of Reference That Puts Your Strengths at the Center	Understand your ideal prospects and product attributes to choose a market frame that highlights your value.
Choosing the Right Market Frame of Reference	Market definitions should resonate with customer perceptions rather than introducing new categories unless intentional; positioning informs customer comparisons.
Strategies for Selecting a Market Frame	Abductive Reasoning: Identify features and values to align with typical product categories. Adjacent Markets: Explore neighboring markets for better recognition of strengths. Customer Input: Gather customer feedback carefully, as perspectives may be limited.
Positioning Story: Wattpad's Transformation	Wattpad transitioned from a storytelling platform to a global entertainment company by leveraging data and redefining itself with media partnerships.
Positioning Styles	Head to Head: Compete directly in an established market. Big Fish, Small Pond: Target a subsegment with unmet needs. Create a New Game: Establish a new market category when necessary.
Positioning Story: Janna Systems' CRM Success	By focusing exclusively on investment banks, Janna Systems differentiated from competitors and achieved significant growth.
Implementation of Positioning Styles	Ensure competitive advantage for Head to Head. Verify substantial subsegment for Big Fish, Small Pond. Prepare for market education in Creating a New Game.
Conclusion	Selecting the right market frame involves understanding customer needs, evaluating the competition, and leveraging strengths for successful market positioning.

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STEP 8: Find a Market Frame of Reference That Puts Your Strengths at the Center

You have an understanding of your ideal prospects and your product's unique attributes. The next step is to select a market frame of reference that highlights your value. This is crucial, as the market category you initially considered may no longer be the best fit due to your offering's evolution and changes in customer viewpoints.

Choosing the Right Market Frame of Reference

-
Market Definition
: A market must resonate with existing customer perceptions, rather than being a newly defined category unless you are intentionally crafting one.
-
Positioning
: Positioning your offering within a specific market informs customers what to compare you against, assisting in their understanding and purchase decision.

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Strategies for Selecting a Market Frame

1.
Abductive Reasoning
: Identify key features and value to find typical product categories that align.
2.
Adjacent Markets
: Explore neighboring markets where your strengths might be better recognized.
3.
Customer Input
: Engage customers for feedback about their perception of your market but proceed cautiously, as their perspective may be limited.

Positioning Story: Wattpad’s Transformation

Wattpad began as a social storytelling platform for mobile users but evolved into a global entertainment company by leveraging its data about storytelling. After success in adapting its stories for TV, Wattpad transitioned to working with major media brands and redefined itself as an entertainment company, growing its user base significantly.

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Positioning Styles

1.
Head to Head
: Compete in an existing market to be the leader. This strategy works best when you can outmatch competitors on established purchase criteria.

2.
Big Fish, Small Pond
: Focus on a subsegment of the market with distinct needs unmet by leaders, allowing easier targeting and quicker traction.
3.
Create a New Game
: Invent a new market category when existing ones don’t apply. This requires substantial effort and resources to educate the market and establish yourself as a leader.

Positioning Story: Janna Systems’ CRM Success

Initially struggling as a CRM provider, Janna Systems pivoted to focus exclusively on investment banks, effectively

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differentiating itself from the dominant player, Siebel Systems. This shift led to significant revenue growth and ultimately culminated in a lucrative acquisition.

Implementation of Positioning Styles

When employing each strategy:

- **Head to Head**: Ensure a credible competitive advantage exists.
- **Big Fish, Small Pond**: Verify the subsegment is substantial enough to achieve business goals.
- **Create a New Game**: Prepare for extensive market education and the possibility of managing or combating competitors asserting that your offering is just a feature.

Conclusion

The journey of selecting the right market frame and positioning your product involves understanding customer

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needs, evaluating competitive landscapes, and leveraging your unique strengths to define your place in the market successfully.

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Critical Thinking

Key Point:The Importance of Market Frame Selection in Positioning

Critical Interpretation:April Dunford emphasizes that choosing an appropriate market frame of reference is crucial for effectively communicating a product's strengths. However, some may argue that rigid adherence to existing market definitions can stifle innovation and limit potential opportunities to redefine customer perceptions. It is essential to recognize that while Dunford's insights are valuable, different market dynamics might necessitate alternative strategies. For instance, the concept of 'Blue Ocean Strategy' suggests that creating uncontested market space can yield a competitive advantage, a perspective that indicates that traditional categories may not always be relevant (Kim & Mauborgne, 2005). Thus, readers are encouraged to critically assess Dunford’s perspective and consider the evolving nature of markets.

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Chapter 11 Summary : Step 9. Layer On a Trend (but Be Careful)

STEP 9. Layer On a Trend (but Be Careful)

When determining your market context, consider layering a trend on your positioning to enhance customer understanding of your offering's current relevance. This optional tactic can be powerful if done cautiously. Visualize the intersection of your product's strengths, market context, and customer-relevant trends.

An example is a startup that provided a product for retail sales associates, allowing them access to both e-commerce and in-store information. They aligned their product with the trend of “mobility,” as retailers were keen on equipping sales associates with tablets. This alignment helped reinforce their product's value.

While it's possible for well-positioned products to succeed without linking to a trend, integrating relevant trends can make offerings appear timely and interesting. Caution is advised; if a trend doesn't align with your positioning, it risks muddling your message. Sometimes, a straightforward

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approach is preferable to overcomplicating with trends.

POSITIONING STORY: Redgate Software

Redgate Software is a leader in the database tools market, providing essential services with over 800,000 users. Despite their success, customers viewed their offerings as not urgent or "cool." To enhance their storytelling, Redgate aligned their products with the trending concept of DevOps, emphasizing the importance of databases in the process. They produced relevant content and trained their sales team to consult with development teams.
This approach led to an increase in customers purchasing multiple products and a 100% rise in inbound leads, indicating a shift in perception toward their products as a priority.

CAUTIONARY TALES ABOUT TRENDS

Describing a trend without defining a market can lead to confusion and muddled messaging. For instance, a company illustrated their app as "the sharing economy for pets," but clarity came only after detailing their actual market—a pet service marketplace.

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Trends must have a clear connection to your product. Don't get lost in content creation focused on trends without linking back to your actual solution, as demonstrated by the failed rebranding of Long Island Iced Tea to Long Blockchain, which lacked a coherent strategy related to their existing products.

While integrating trends into your positioning can be beneficial, it's crucial to maintain alignment with your product. Companies can thrive without trendy associations and might be better off embracing stability over hype.

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Chapter 12 Summary : Step 10. Capture Your Positioning so It Can Be Shared

Section	Content
STEP 10	Capture Your Positioning so It Can Be Shared
Importance of Positioning Communication	Positioning calls for company-wide buy-in for effective branding, marketing, sales strategy, product decisions, and customer success.
The Challenge of Positioning Statements	Positioning statements are often too brief and contrived, failing to convey product nuances for easy memorization.
Creating a Detailed Positioning Document	A comprehensive document detailing each component of positioning is recommended as a resource for marketing, sales, and product development.
Short and Concise Communication	A single-page summary and a positioning canvas are recommended for easy sharing across the company.
The Positioning Canvas Structure	Product Name and Description: Identification of the product. Market Category: Macro market and relevant subcategories. Competitive Alternatives: Identifying substitutes customers may consider. Unique Attributes: Features exclusive to the product. Value: Benefits those attributes offer to customers. Target Customers: Characteristics of customers likely to value the product.

STEP 10: Capture Your Positioning so It Can Be Shared

Importance of Positioning Communication

Positioning is not effective unless shared throughout the organization. For successful implementation in branding,

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marketing, sales strategy, product decisions, and customer success, company-wide buy-in is essential.

The Challenge of Positioning Statements

A common issue with positioning statements is their brevity, which often fails to capture product nuances. They tend to be too contrived for easy memorization.

Creating a Detailed Positioning Document

It is recommended to create a comprehensive document that details each component of the positioning. This document should clarify how each element interacts, serving as a resource for marketing, sales, and product development.

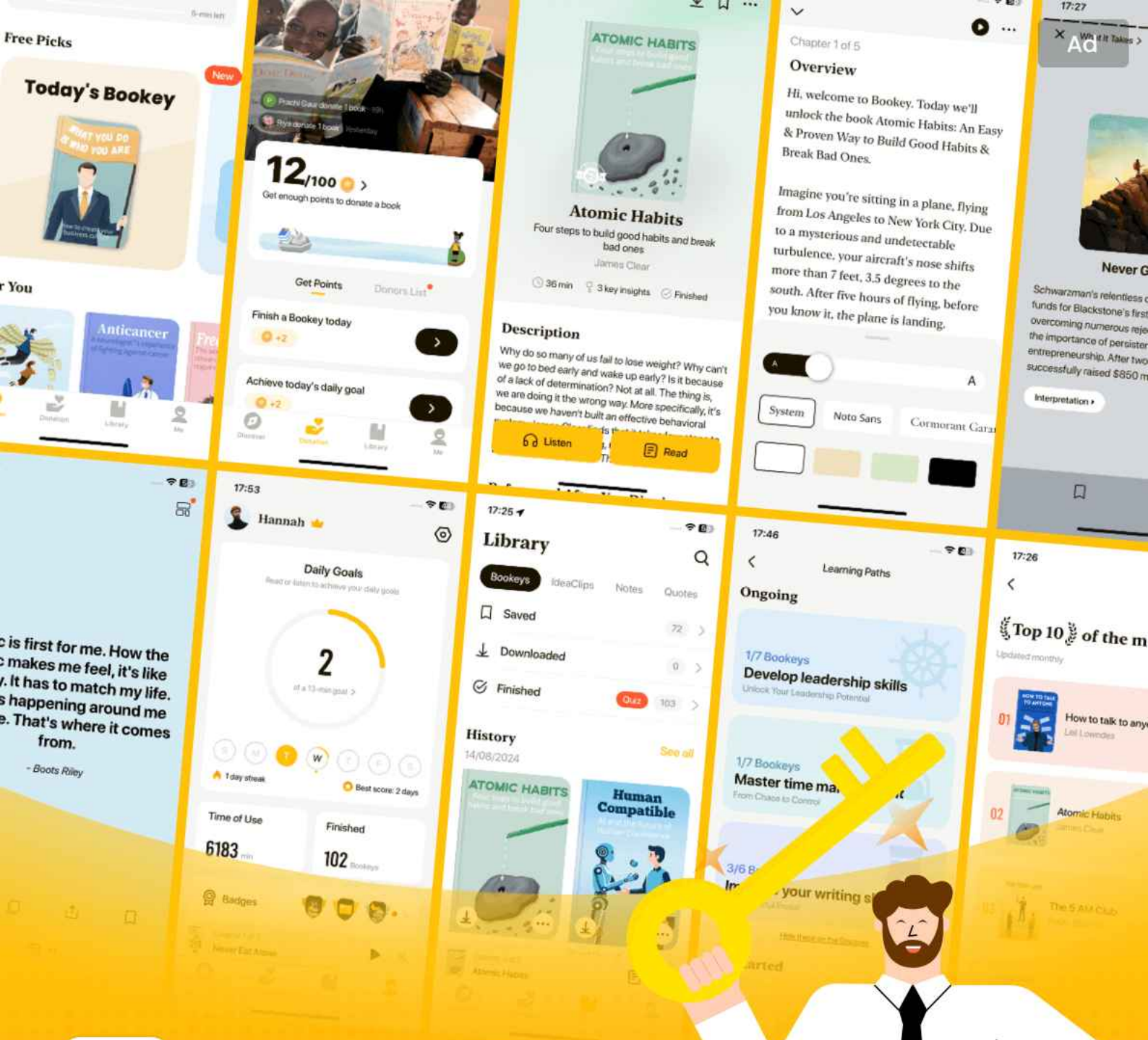
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Chapter 13 Summary : After Positioning: What Happens Next?

AFTER POSITIONING: WHAT HAPPENS NEXT?

When positioning workshops conclude, the immediate question often is what to do next. While the positioning exercise is valuable for unifying the team around differentiated value and target segments, the next step is implementing this positioning throughout the company.

Translating Your Positioning into a Sales Story

1.
Importance of Sales Story:
For businesses with complex sales cycles, embedding positioning into sales conversations is crucial. The sales story helps frame how products are pitched to prospects.

2.
Components of a Sales Story:

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-

Problem Definition

: Clearly outline the problem your solution addresses.

-

Current Solutions

: Describe how existing solutions fall short.

-

Perfect World Scenario

: Illustrate what an ideal solution looks like.

-

Product Introduction

: Present your product within the relevant market category.

-

Value Themes

: Detail how the solution delivers value.

-

Next Steps

: Conclude with a call to action for the prospect.

The goal is to create agreement on how positioning translates into pitches.

Messaging

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Once the sales story is defined, the marketing team should translate it into specific messaging for campaigns and materials. A messaging document should be created as a foundational reference to ensure consistency and prevent message drift.

Product Roadmap and Pricing

Changes in positioning usually affect marketing and sales but can also influence product feature prioritization and pricing. Incorporating adjustments that reflect new positioning helps maintain relevance in the market.

Tracking Your Positioning over Time

- Regularly reassess positioning, ideally every six months or after significant market changes.
- A shift in competitive landscape can necessitate reevaluation. Monitor customer perceptions and the relevance of competitors.
- External factors, such as regulatory changes or technological advancements, can affect positioning.
- Customer attitudes can evolve, impacting buying decisions. Awareness of these shifts is crucial to maintaining a strong

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market position.

Overall, positioning should be viewed as a dynamic business strategy rather than a static marketing element.

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Chapter 14 Summary : Conclusion

CONCLUSION

In summary, early in my career, positioning products felt unpredictable, influenced by buyer behavior, market unpredictability, and luck. However, I learned that I could significantly influence product positioning through experience and observation of successful strategies. By sharing insights, I aim to help you improve your own positioning skills. Having this book has given you a clear, 10-step process for positioning any product, with three distinct styles tailored to your market.

Key Takeaways

1. Products can be positioned in multiple markets; they’re not limited to one.
2. Effective positioning is intentional; practice and iteration are crucial for success.
3. Recognizing competitors helps identify your differentiators.
4. Choose a market that highlights your strengths.

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5. Use trends wisely; prioritize clarity and substance over mere trendiness.
Learning to communicate complex skills effectively is vital; this book aims to simplify the positioning process to help you succeed.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

April Dunford is an expert in positioning and market strategy, assisting technology companies in making their products comprehensible and appealing. With over twenty-five years as a VP of marketing, she has launched numerous successful products and provides guidance through training and workshops.

Work with April Dunford to Take Your Customers from “What?” to “WOW!”

Proper positioning can transform customer understanding of your product amidst overwhelming choices. April Dunford offers a practical methodology for showcasing your product's value.

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A hands-on session to refine your product positioning and develop a compelling sales narrative.

-

Two-hour course for larger teams:

An intensive overview of positioning best practices, tailored for established organizations.

-

Ninety-minute group workshop for startups:

A dynamic session designed for early-stage founders focusing on foundational positioning concepts.

-

Customized workshops:

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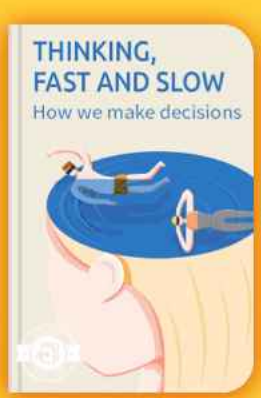
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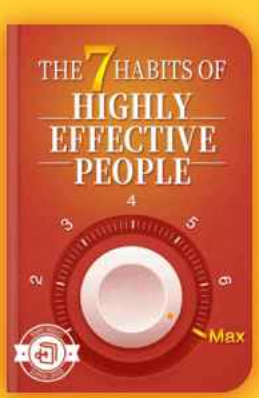
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Chapter 1 | Quotes From Pages 27-41

1. Positioning products is a lot like context setting in the opening of a movie.
2. Context allows us to make thousands of little decisions about what we should pay attention to and what we can simply ignore.
3. Even a world-class product, poorly positioned, can fail.
4. Most products are exceptional only when we understand them within their best frame of reference.
5. Without meaning to, we trap ourselves within our own context.
6. Changing our context not only changed the way customers viewed our product, it changed the way we saw ourselves.
7. How you position your offerings is the underpinning of your entire business strategy and can mean the difference between success and failure.

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Chapter 2 | Quotes From Pages 42-56

1. You cannot be everything to everyone. If you decide to go north, you cannot go south at the same time.” JEROEN DE FL ANDER
2. Sit, walk or run, but don’t wobble.” ZEN PROVERB
3. Every year, Pantone, inventors of the Pantone Color Matching System, selects a ‘color of the year.’ In 2019, it’s ‘living coral’ (or pink, for us regular folks). Companies then create pink clothing, lipstick and furniture to be on trend.
4. The value of our solution is really well aligned with direct-to-consumer initiatives,” Marie explains. “Our solution helps them rapidly build out a targeted buyer list and get deeper insights about consumer behavior and preferences.
5. Because these relationships flow from one another, the order in which you define the components is very important.

Chapter 3 | Quotes From Pages 59-66

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1. Your best-fit customers hold the key to understanding what your product is.
2. If everything depends on everything else, where on earth do we start in what seems to be a circular process?
3. Take a wide set of potential customers… to see patterns emerge.
4. Positioning your net broadly as a ‘fish net’ when you have little market experience is the best way to keep your options open.
5. Their business model also shifted as they announced new services including payroll and payments that were available on a transaction fee basis.

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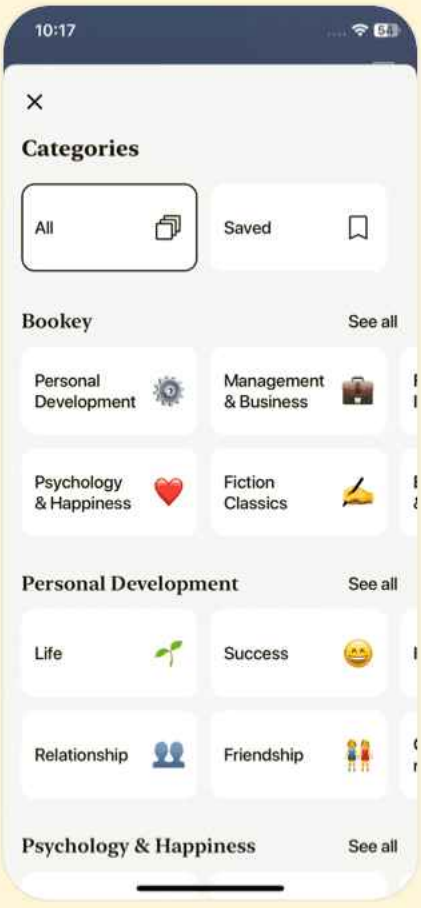
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Chapter 4 | Quotes From Pages 67-70

1. A positioning process works best when it’s a team effort, ideally from across different functions within the company.
2. Positioning is a business strategy exercise—the person who owns the business strategy needs to fully support the positioning, or it’s unlikely to be adopted.
3. Positioning impacts every group in the organization.
4. You want engagement from every group because you need buy-in from every group.
5. Having someone from outside the company facilitate the discussion will make the exercise much more productive and balanced.

Chapter 5 | Quotes From Pages 71-75

1. We have the power to imagine better.” J.K. ROWLING
2. The goal of the 10-Step Positioning Process is to find the best position for a product, one that puts the product in the context of a market where it can easily win because the

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product has obvious benefits over alternatives.

3. Freeing your mind from patterns of the past isn't always easy.
4. Being conscious of the presence of your history in your current position will help everyone be open to alternatives.
5. Positioning themselves in the robot category put them in direct comparison with other robot vendors whose solutions were nothing like Clearpath's offering.

Chapter 6 | Quotes From Pages 76-78

1. Customers don't always see competitors the same way we do, and their opinion is the only one that matters for positioning.
2. If problems are the root, why not start by asking customers what problems they're trying to solve?
3. The best way to understand competitive alternatives is to answer the question, What would our best customers do if we didn't exist?
4. Focus on your best customers and what they would identify as alternative solutions.

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5.Grouping the alternatives helps the team move to the next step.

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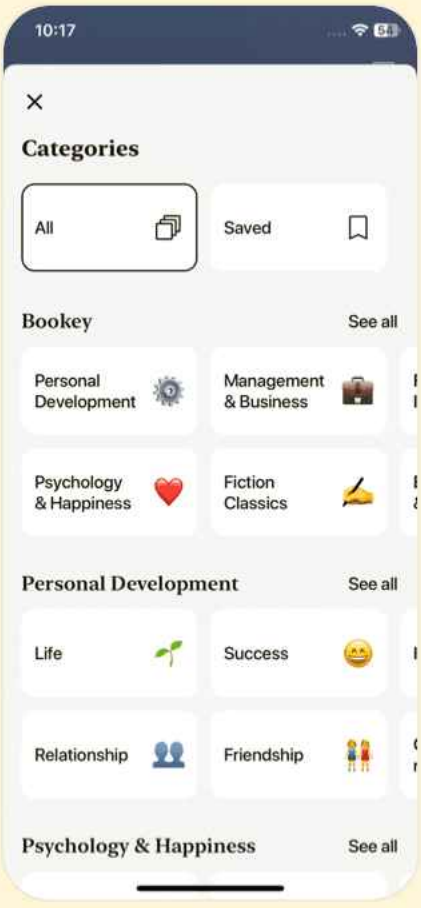
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Chapter 7 | Quotes From Pages 79-82

1. Sometimes it is helpful to think about the feedback you get from customers when you ask them why they chose your offering.
2. Your opinion of your own strengths is irrelevant without proof.
3. Be broad and creative with the attributes you list.
4. Concentration on 'consideration' rather than 'retention' attributes.
5. If you truly believe that your company is better at customer service, how would you go about proving that?
6. We don’t know who discovered water, but we’re certain it wasn’t a fish." - JOHN CULKIN

Chapter 8 | Quotes From Pages 83-86

1. The stone age didn’t end because they ran out of stones.

Chapter 9 | Quotes From Pages 87-91

1. It’s important to remember that although you have unique attributes that deliver value to

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customers, not all customers care about that value in exactly the same way.

2. Your best-fit customers are easiest to sell to and retain.
3. The broader your focus, the more difficult it is to connect with prospects and convince them that your solution is the best one for them above all others.
4. If you have limited marketing and sales resources, it makes sense to spend them on prospects that are most like your best-fit customers.
5. Keep in mind that your product positioning will constantly be evolving.
6. In general, the segment needs to meet at least two criteria to be worthy of focus: it needs to be big enough that it's possible to meet the goals of your business, and it needs to have important, specific, unmet needs that are common to the segment.

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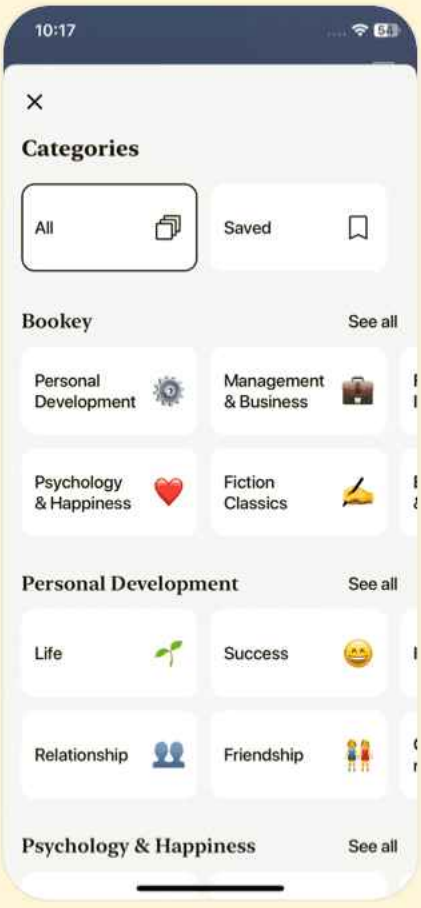
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Chapter 10 | Quotes From Pages 92-116

1. If it looks like a duck, swims like a duck and quacks like a duck, then it probably is a duck.
2. But be careful—simply wanting to belong in a market doesn't make it the right one for you.
3. Even as early as 2012 we knew that our platform was creating a huge number of incredible, well-loved stories. We knew we could do more with them off the platform, potentially adapting stories for TV and movies.
4. This positioning shift immediately got us away from trying to compete with Oracle, and it aligned with our strengths.
5. The most successful efforts in category creation do not result from company executives creating an acronym at an offsite. Rather they are discovered from deeply understanding a narrow set of customers.
6. The future isn't a place we are going to go, it's a place we get to create.

Chapter 11 | Quotes From Pages 117-122

1. If you change the way you look at things, the

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things you look at change." WAYNE DYER

2.Describing a trend without declaring a market can make your product cool but bauling.

3.Trends can only be used when they have a clear link to your product.

4.Many companies operate perfectly fine in markets that don’t have much sizzle and pizzazz.

Chapter 12 | Quotes From Pages 123-124

1.Positioning needs to have company buy-in so it can be used to inform branding, marketing campaigns, sales strategy, product decisions and customer-success strategy.

2.I’m a fan of having a shorter, concise version of the positioning that can be captured on a single page and easily shared across the company.

3.This document should break down each individual component of the position, give enough detail for each to be understood and show how they interact with one another.

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4.It then lets you line up competitive alternatives, attributes, value and customer segments in a way that shows the relationship between them.

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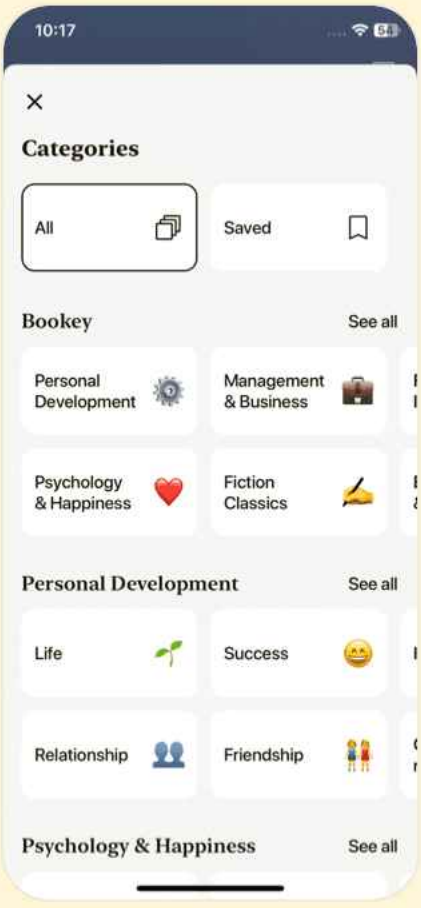
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Chapter 13 | Quotes From Pages 127-134

1. The most obvious immediate next thing after a change in positioning is to create new messaging that reflects the positioning.
2. The point of working through the sales story is that everyone in the discussion can agree on how the positioning translates into a 'pitch.'
3. Every campaign you create or new piece of material you build is going to have a slightly different purpose and slightly different messaging.
4. Great positioning is usually strengthened over time with adjustments in features.
5. If you want success, be unique.

Chapter 14 | Quotes From Pages 135-140

1. Any product can be positioned in multiple markets. Your product is not doomed to languish in a market where nobody understands how awesome it is.
2. Great positioning rarely comes by default. If you want to

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succeed, you have to determine the best way to position your product. Deliberate, try, fail, test and try again.

3. Understanding what your best customers see as true alternatives to your solution will lead you to your differentiators.
4. Position yourself in a market that makes your strengths obvious to the folks you want to sell to.
5. Don’t layer on a trend just for the sake of being trendy—it’s better to be successful and boring, rather than fashionable and bewildering.
6. Knowing how to do something is not the same as understanding how to teach someone else how to do it.

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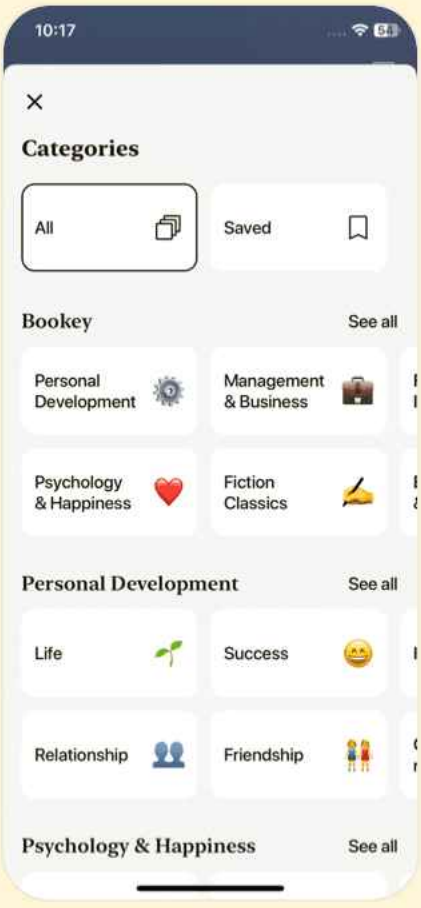
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Chapter 1 | Positioning as Context| Q&A

1.Question

Why is context important in product positioning?

Answer:Context allows customers to quickly understand what a product is, who it’s for, and why it matters, similar to how an opening scene in a movie sets the stage for the story.

2.Question

What happened to Joshua Bell when he played in the subway?

Answer:Despite being a world-class violinist, Joshua Bell's performance went largely unnoticed in the subway, illustrating how context can affect the perception of value.

3.Question

How does the framing of a product change its market strategy?

Answer:Changing how a product is framed, such as shifting

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from 'cake' to 'muffin' or 'data warehouse' to 'database', can drastically alter target markets, pricing, and competition.

4.Question

What is the 'default' positioning trap?

Answer:It's the assumption that a product should only be seen in the context intended by its creators, without considering alternative perspectives that might better resonate with customers.

5.Question

How can shifts in market context impact a product's success?

Answer:As market perceptions change, a product that was once well-positioned can become irrelevant if it doesn't adapt its messaging and context to align with new consumer values.

6.Question

What is an example of how a product's positioning can evolve over time?

Answer:A bakery might start with a 'diet muffin' positioning but could find greater success by rebranding the same

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product as a 'gluten-free paleo snack', reflecting changing health trends.

7.Question

What is the primary challenge discussed regarding product creators?

Answer:Product creators often fall into the trap of not deliberately positioning their product, leading to missed opportunities and confusion among potential customers.

8.Question

Why is it essential to communicate a product's unique value through positioning?

Answer:Effective positioning makes it easier for customers to understand what makes a product special, which can capture their attention and drive sales.

9.Question

What are the consequences of poor product positioning?

Answer:Poor positioning can lead customers to overlook a product entirely or misinterpret its purpose, causing potential losses in sales and market relevance.

10.Question

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How can the way we perceive a product change its acceptance in the market?

Answer:By changing how a product is described or categorized, such as rebranding a 'cake on a stick' to a 'cake pop', it can align better with consumer expectations and increase appeal.

Chapter 2 | The Five (plus One) Components of Effective Positioning| Q&A

1.Question

What is the primary issue with traditional positioning statements according to the author?

Answer:Traditional positioning statements assume you already know the correct inputs to fill in, which often reflects only current assumptions without stimulating creative thinking about product positioning. They fail to provide actionable insights and instead encourage reinforcing the status quo.

2.Question

Why is understanding competitive alternatives essential for effective positioning?

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Answer:Understanding competitive alternatives is crucial because it allows you to see what customers compare your solution against, which shapes their perception of 'better.' It helps you identify where your product stands in relation to alternatives they might use if your solution didn't exist.

3.Question

How do unique attributes relate to the competitive landscape?

Answer:Unique attributes are the features that distinguish your product from competitive alternatives. They must genuinely offer something that competitors lack, affecting the way customers perceive value against the backdrop of market choices.

4.Question

What role does value play in the positioning framework?

Answer:Value articulates the benefits your unique attributes deliver to customers. It needs to be tangible and provable, as customers are more likely to be influenced by verifiable proof rather than subjective claims.

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5.Question

Why must target market characteristics be well-defined in positioning?

Answer:Defining target market characteristics ensures that marketing and sales efforts are directed towards the customers most likely to appreciate and benefit from the product, optimizing resource allocation and increasing conversion rates.

6.Question

What is the significance of selecting the right market category in positioning?

Answer:Choosing the appropriate market category acts as a shorthand for customers, helping them categorize your product. It frames their expectations about features and pricing, providing context to your unique value.

7.Question

How can trends enhance the relevance of a product's positioning?

Answer:Trends provide context that aligns a product with current customer interests or market needs, making the

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product appear urgent and relevant. This connection can significantly influence buyers who do not want to miss out on innovations.

8.Question

Explain the relationship between different components of positioning as described in the chapter.

Answer:The components of positioning are interdependent: unique attributes need to be understood in the context of competitive alternatives, which defines the value. Identifying the target market derives from the value proposition, which leads to the best-fitting market category. Trends can highlight why this value is important right now, reinforcing the entire positioning strategy.

9.Question

Why is it essential to follow a specific order when defining the positioning components?

Answer:It's essential to define positioning components in order — starting with competitive alternatives — to ensure a logical flow that aligns with how customers evaluate

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solutions. Jumping ahead can lead to mismatched positioning that doesn't resonate with customer evaluations.

10.Question

What is the suggested outcome of effectively executing the 10-step positioning process?

Answer:Successfully executing the 10-step positioning process will enable a company to clearly define its market ownership, effectively communicate its value proposition, and ultimately connect with its target audience in a meaningful way.

Chapter 3 | Step 1. Understand the Customers Who Love Your Product| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of understanding your happiest customers when positioning a product?

Answer:Understanding your happiest customers can reveal key insights into what makes your product valuable to them and why they prefer it over alternatives. By focusing on these customers, you can identify patterns and characteristics that

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represent your ideal market fit. This allows you to tailor your marketing efforts to attract similar customers and refine your positioning based on real feedback, leading to increased growth and satisfaction.

2.Question

How can divergent customer groups affect your positioning strategy?

Answer:Encountering a heterogenous customer base means that while many customers may use your product, they may value different features or benefits. By testing your product across a diverse audience, you can identify which customer segments respond the most positively, enabling you to refine your positioning to better target those groups. This strategic focus maximizes the effectiveness of your marketing efforts.

3.Question

Why shouldn’t you start with product features when positioning?

Answer:Starting with product features can lead you to

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inadvertently compare your offering to competitors in a narrow frame. Instead, positioning should begin by understanding customer needs and perceptions, as they may differ significantly from your internal view of competition. Focusing on customer requirements rather than just features ensures that your positioning resonates with their immediate pain points rather than an abstract vision.

4.Question

What should guide your positioning if you are a single-product company?

Answer:As a single-product company, your positioning efforts should primarily focus on your product itself, aligning your brand with the product to avoid confusion among customers. This approach enables customers to easily understand what you offer without the complexity of distinguishing between multiple products or branding.

5.Question

How did Wave transition from 'accounting software' to a broader financial services provider, and what was the impact?

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Answer:Wave transitioned from being an 'accounting software' company to a 'financial software' provider in response to customer demands for more integrated financial product offerings. By dropping 'Accounting' from their name and refocusing their messaging, they positioned themselves more clearly in the financial services space. This shift contributed to their significant growth, increasing their customer base from 500,000 to over 4 million by 2019, demonstrating the power of adaptive positioning based on customer needs.

6.Question

What does the 'fishing net' analogy teach us about market strategy?

Answer:The fishing net analogy illustrates the concept of experimentation in product positioning and market strategy. Just as a fisherman initially casts a wide net to see what catches they can get, businesses should approach their market with an open mind. By experimenting with different customer segments, you can discover where your product

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resonates best before narrowing your focus based on actual customer feedback and preferences.

7.Question

How should the positioning process differ for investors compared to customers?

Answer:Positioning for investors should emphasize the long-term vision and potential growth of the company, while customer positioning focuses on immediate value and solutions to current problems. This dual perspective ensures that while investors are reassured about future plans, customers understand the current benefits and relevance of the product to their needs.

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Chapter 4 | Step 2. Form a Positioning Team| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to form a positioning team for developing product positioning?

Answer:Forming a positioning team ensures a collaborative effort that leverages diverse perspectives from different departments like sales, marketing, and customer success. This collaboration helps to reveal various assumptions about customer perception and product value, aligning the entire organization towards a cohesive positioning strategy.

2.Question

Who should lead the positioning exercise and why?

Answer:The positioning exercise should be led by the person responsible for the business strategy of the product, which is typically the CEO or a division leader. Their involvement is crucial because successful positioning is a strategic decision that impacts the entire company and must be supported at the

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highest levels.

3.Question

What role does each department play in the positioning process?

Answer:Each department plays a critical role in the positioning process: Marketing can develop effective messaging and campaigns, Sales can focus on customer segmentation and account strategies, Customer Success can ensure proper onboarding and expansion strategies, and Product Development can provide insights on competitive differentiators and product capabilities.

4.Question

Why is it advised to have an experienced facilitator during the positioning workshop?

Answer:An experienced facilitator can guide the discussion effectively, ensuring that all voices are heard and challenging entrenched assumptions. This external perspective can help navigate complex strategic issues and make the workshop more productive, leading to more balanced and innovative

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positioning outcomes.

5.Question

What is a key takeaway regarding the number of participants in the positioning team?

Answer:Having one or two senior representatives from each functional group is ideal for ensuring diverse input while preventing dominance by any single group. Too many participants can complicate discussions and dilute contributions, making it important to keep the team size manageable.

6.Question

How does the quote by Zora Neale Hurston relate to the positioning process?

Answer:The quote emphasizes the importance of clear communication within the positioning team. It highlights that successful discussions and decisions rely on ensuring that all members understand each other's perspectives and contributions, which is vital in developing shared positioning across the company.

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7.Question

Why might positioning discussions fail if only the marketing team is involved?

Answer:If only the marketing team is involved, the positioning may lack critical insights from other departments that interact with customers, leading to a narrow view of the market. Positioning must reflect a comprehensive understanding of the product and its customer base, which can only be achieved through collaboration across all relevant departments.

8.Question

How can the positioning process influence overall business strategy?

Answer:Positioning shapes how a product is perceived in the market, directly impacting marketing strategies, sales approaches, customer onboarding, and product development. A clear positioning strategy thus becomes intertwined with the overall business strategy, driving alignment across all areas of the organization.

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Chapter 5 | Step 3. Align Your Positioning Vocabulary and Let Go of Your Positioning Baggage| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of aligning your team's positioning vocabulary in product positioning?

Answer:Aligning your team's positioning vocabulary is crucial because it ensures that all members have a common understanding of what positioning is and why it matters. This common language prevents confusion and arguments during discussions about the product's future. When everyone is on the same page about concepts and definitions, the team can effectively collaborate to discover a new, effective position for the product, ultimately increasing the chance of success.

2.Question

How can letting go of 'positioning baggage' benefit a product's success?

Answer:Letting go of 'positioning baggage' allows teams to

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shift their perspective and explore new markets and opportunities that they may have previously overlooked due to traditional thinking. By freeing their minds from past definitions and uses of the product, they can innovate and reposition it in ways that resonate better with current market needs and consumer perceptions, much like how Arm & Hammer transformed their baking soda into a deodorizing product, leading to significant sales growth.

3.Question

What does the story of Clearpath Robotics teach us about product positioning?

Answer:The story of Clearpath Robotics illustrates the importance of redefining and clarifying product positioning in a way that resonates with customer expectations. Initially, their product was misunderstood as just another robot, but by rebranding and repositioning it as 'self-driving vehicles for industrial uses,' they created a clearer context for customers. This shift not only improved customer understanding but also enhanced sales and attracted investment, showing that

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effective positioning can lead to substantial business success.

4.Question

Why is it essential for team members to be aware of their 'positioning baggage'?

Answer:Awareness of 'positioning baggage' helps team members recognize how their historical perspectives might cloud their judgment about the product's current market relevance. By understanding their own biases and assumptions, teams can better collaborate to identify and agree on new positioning strategies without being hindered by outdated ideas. This awareness fosters an openness to innovative ideas, which is key to effective repositioning.

5.Question

What can companies learn from the evolution of Arm & Hammer's product positioning?

Answer:Companies can learn that flexibility and a willingness to evolve their product's positioning can lead to new avenues of success. Arm & Hammer's ability to pivot from a baking soda for cooking to a deodorizer showcases

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the need to continually assess market trends and consumer behavior. This adaptability can unlock additional revenue streams and amplify brand recognition when executed thoughtfully.

6.Question

How can Clearpath Robotics' approach to repositioning be applied to other industries?

Answer:Clearpath Robotics' approach can be applied to other industries by utilizing innovative thinking to redefine existing products in a way that addresses emerging needs or consumer perceptions. Companies should focus on understanding what makes their offerings unique and then communicate that through branding and marketing strategies that align with customers' expectations and experiences in their respective sectors.

7.Question

What role does market maturity play in shaping product positioning?

Answer:Market maturity influences product positioning

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significantly, as it dictates how competitive the landscape is and what consumers expect from products within that market. New or emerging markets may allow for more creative or innovative positions, while mature markets may necessitate a focus on differentiation to stand out among established competitors. Understanding this dynamic helps companies choose the most effective positioning strategies tailored to their specific market context.

Chapter 6 | Step 4. List Your True Competitive Alternatives| Q&A

1.Question

Why is it important to understand the competitive alternatives from the customer’s perspective rather than the company’s perspective?

Answer:Understanding competitive alternatives from the customer’s perspective is crucial because it shapes how customers perceive your product's value. A company may focus solely on its features, but if customers do not view those features as competitive or relevant compared to their

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alternatives, the product's positioning will be ineffective. This approach ensures that marketing and communication resonate with what customers truly value and their actual decision-making processes.

2.Question

What method can be used to identify true competitive alternatives for your product?

Answer:To identify true competitive alternatives, ask the question, 'What would our best customers do if we didn’t exist?' This approach not only reveals whether customers would turn to direct competitors, but also highlights potentially overlooked alternatives like simpler solutions or even doing nothing, which may provide insight into how customers categorize your solution.

3.Question

What should teams focus on when creating a list of competitive alternatives?

Answer:Teams should focus on their best-fit customers and

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identify alternatives that those customers would realistically consider. It's crucial to rank the alternatives from most common to least common to maintain a clear perspective on the most relevant competitive landscape.

4.Question

How can categorizing alternatives help in the positioning process?

Answer:Categorizing alternatives helps to identify patterns in customer behavior and decision-making, making it easier to understand the competitive landscape. It allows teams to clarify their product's unique strengths and determine how to present those effectively, enabling them to move to the next step in the positioning process.

5.Question

What traps should teams avoid when listing competitive alternatives?

Answer:Teams should avoid creating an exhaustive list of every possible alternative without prioritizing the most relevant solutions for their best customers. Additionally, they

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should not include competitors with minimal customer awareness, as real competition comes from solutions customers actively consider.

6.Question

How does the nuance in customer descriptions of their problems impact product positioning?

Answer:Customer descriptions of their problems can often lack the nuance needed for product creators to accurately understand how their solutions fit into the customer's world. Product creators must therefore dig deeper by understanding not just the problems, but also how customers are comparing their product to other alternatives, which informs more effective positioning.

7.Question

What broader implications does effectively identifying competitive alternatives have for a business?

Answer:Effectively identifying competitive alternatives can significantly enhance a business's overall strategic positioning, allowing it to communicate its unique value

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proposition clearly. It impacts marketing, product development, customer engagement, and can lead to better customer satisfaction and retention by aligning offerings with actual customer needs and perceptions.

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Chapter 7 | Step 5. Isolate Your Unique Attributes or Features| Q&A

1.Question

What should be the focus when isolating unique attributes or features of a product?

Answer:The focus should be on features and capabilities that uniquely define your product compared to competitive alternatives, rather than the value these features provide to customers.

2.Question

What are examples of product features to consider?

Answer:Examples of product features include 'a 15-megapixel camera', 'integrates with QuickBooks', 'one-click installation', and 'metal construction'.

3.Question

How should companies approach listing their unique features?

Answer:Companies should list all capabilities they possess, including those that might be seen as negatives, as they may be perceived positively by certain customers.

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4.Question

Why is customer feedback important in identifying unique attributes?

Answer:Customer feedback provides insight into why customers chose your offering over others, helping to identify unique combinations of skills and features that differentiate you.

5.Question

What is an example of a feature seen as negative by some but positive by others?

Answer:A software company requiring professional services for onsite installation is seen as a negative by some for longer setup times but as a positive by others who value customization and high-touch service.

6.Question

Why is proof important when listing features?

Answer:Proof is crucial because an opinion about a feature's strength is irrelevant without objective evidence, making attributes credible and trustworthy to potential customers.

7.Question

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What strategy can illustrate a company's excellent customer service objectively?

Answer:Companies can provide proof of excellent customer service by showing metrics such as having more support personnel than competitors or having higher certification levels.

8.Question

What is the difference between consideration attributes and retention attributes?

Answer:Consideration attributes are important during the purchase evaluation process based on immediate customer goals, while retention attributes relate to long-term satisfaction and support after purchase.

9.Question

How should a company approach the list of attributes at this stage of the process?

Answer:Companies should capture as many attributes as possible without prematurely filtering for importance, as this full range will be grouped for further analysis in the next

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steps.

10.Question

What mindset should companies adopt when evaluating their features?

Answer:Companies should adopt a broad and creative mindset, looking beyond just product features to include partnerships, expertise, processes, and skills that make them unique.

Chapter 8 | Step 6. Map the Attributes to Value “Themes”| Q&A

1.Question

What is the main purpose of mapping attributes to value themes?

Answer:The main purpose is to translate product attributes into customer-relevant benefits and values, ensuring that features are understood in the context of the goals customers are trying to achieve.

2.Question

How can features lead to specific customer benefits?

Answer:Features like a '15-megapixel camera' provide the

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benefit of 'sharp photo images,' which in turn translates to the value of being able to print or zoom in on images without losing quality.

3.Question

Why is it important to articulate value clearly to customers?

Answer:It is crucial to clearly articulate value because customers often don’t automatically understand the significance of features; explicit value articulation helps them see how the product meets their specific needs.

4.Question

What are some examples of how features can lead to value?

Answer:For example, 'one-click reports' streamline decision-making by providing timely information, enabling better organizational decisions, and '24-hour support' ensures that global teams can get assistance whenever needed.

5.Question

What should be the focus when positioning a product based on features?

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Answer:The focus should be on the most critical features that deliver unique value, avoiding an exhaustive list, and instead highlighting what makes the product truly special and relevant to the customer.

6.Question

How can clustering values into themes be beneficial?

Answer:Clustering values into themes simplifies communication of product value, helping to group related attributes and demonstrating how they collectively support customer needs, which aids in positioning the product more effectively.

7.Question

What might happen if a company fails to connect features to customer benefits?

Answer:If a company fails to connect features to benefits, customers may not see the value in the product and could respond with indifference, inhibiting their understanding of its importance or relevance.

8.Question

What is the quote at the end of the chapter, and what does

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it imply?

Answer:The quote, 'The stone age didn’t end because they ran out of stones,' implies that innovation and the evolution of ideas or products are driven by the context and relevance of their value, not merely by the existence of features.

Chapter 9 | Step 7. Determine Who Cares a Lot| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of identifying customers who care about your product's value?

Answer:Identifying customers who care about your product's value allows you to focus your marketing efforts on segments that are more likely to convert into sales and provide long-term loyalty to your brand. For example, if you have invoicing software that integrates with QuickBooks, targeting businesses that invoice frequently can lead to better sales results versus targeting companies that don't use accounting software.

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2.Question

Why is segmentation often misunderstood in marketing?

Answer:Segmentation is often misunderstood because many marketing courses focus on demographic data, which may not be relevant for every product or market. Effective segmentation should instead focus on identifying specific characteristics and pain points that make certain customer segments value your product more highly.

3.Question

What distinguishes 'best-fit customers' from other customers?

Answer:Best-fit customers are those who resonate strongly with your product, understand its value immediately, and are less price-sensitive. They are more likely to advocate for your product and remain loyal to your brand. In contrast, other customers might see your product as merely acceptable and could easily switch to competitors.

4.Question

How should businesses approach their marketing focus according to their sales objectives?

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Answer:Businesses should aim to focus their marketing strategies on the most fitting customer segments to meet immediate sales objectives. If targeting only best-fit customers can achieve those targets, it is advisable to narrow the focus. Later on, businesses can broaden their segmentation as they grow.

5.Question

What does it mean for positioning to evolve over time?

Answer:Positioning should adapt as both your product and your target customers change. It’s essential to keep positioning relevant to your best-fit customers in the present, rather than trying to fit a long-term vision that may not align with current customer needs.

6.Question

What criteria should be considered when defining a segment?

Answer:A segment should be defined by two main criteria: it must be sizable enough to help meet business goals, and it should represent a group with specific, common unmet needs

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that your product can fulfill. For instance, a segment could be 'accounting software for freelancers', which has unique requirements compared to broader categories.

7.Question

Can you provide an example of how to narrow down a market segment effectively?

Answer:Absolutely! If you're selling sporting goods, instead of broadly targeting all sporting goods consumers, you might narrow your market to 'sporting goods for seniors'. This focuses your marketing efforts on a specific demographic that may have unique needs, such as lightweight equipment or specialized instructional resources.

8.Question

What role do customer pain points play in segmentation?

Answer:Customer pain points are critical in segmentation as they highlight why certain customers will care more about your solution. By identifying specific challenges that a group faces and aligning your product's value to solve those issues, you create a compelling reason for that segment to engage

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with your product.

9.Question

What should you do if your best-fit customer target does not meet your sales objectives?

Answer:If your best-fit customer target does not meet your sales objectives, it is imperative to broaden your definition of who can be considered a best-fit customer. This allows you to include additional segments that may still align with your product's value while ensuring that your business goals are achievable.

10.Question

Why might it be counterintuitive to focus on a narrow market segment?

Answer:Focusing on a narrow market segment may seem counterintuitive because many people believe that a broader focus can generate more leads. However, a narrow focus allows for deeper connections with potential customers who genuinely need your solution, leading to higher conversion rates and stronger customer loyalty.

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Chapter 10 | Step 8. Find a Market Frame of Reference That Puts Your Strengths at the Center and Determine How to Position in It| Q&A

1.Question

What is the importance of choosing the right market frame of reference for positioning a product?

Answer:Choosing the right market frame of reference is crucial as it helps prospects understand the value of your product quickly. It sets the context for comparisons, aligning your unique strengths with what customers already recognize as relevant and valuable. By selecting a market that illustrates your advantages, it also helps trigger favorable assumptions about your product, misleading competitors, features, and pricing that play to your benefit.

2.Question

How can abduction reasoning assist in finding a suitable market frame for a new product?

Answer:Abductive reasoning involves recognizing the key

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features and values of your product and then questioning which markets typically fulfill those features. This method can reveal surprising market opportunities by highlighting how your product aligns with existing customer needs while also focusing on what those customers already understand.

3.Question

Why should you be cautious when asking customers to define your market?

Answer:You should be cautious because customers often only reference their own experiences and familiar contexts. If they have misunderstood your product or its value, their suggestions may misguide you. Instead of positioning you effectively, they might limit your understanding of broader, potentially more advantageous market opportunities.

4.Question

What is the 'Big Fish, Small Pond' strategy, and when should it be employed?

Answer:The 'Big Fish, Small Pond' strategy focuses on dominating a small segment of a larger market where specific

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needs are unmet. This approach is best employed when there's a clear market leader, and you can identify a niche where your strengths meet unaddressed customer demands. It allows you to carve out a space where competition is less fierce while building credibility and brand recognition.

5.Question

What are the risks of the 'Head to Head' positioning style?

Answer:The risks include fierce competition with established market leaders, leading to potential resource drains and struggles to prove superiority. Without a unique competitive advantage, this path can result in being overshadowed by competitors that have already defined customer expectations and established themselves as trusted providers.

6.Question

How can positioning itself in an existing category benefit a new startup?

Answer:Positioning within an established category provides immediate recognition, as customers already have

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preconceived notions about what the category entails. This reduces the need to educate customers about what your product is and allows you to leverage existing market assumptions to gain traction more rapidly.

7.Question

Why is creating a new market category considered difficult, and when is it advisable?

Answer:Creating a new market category is difficult because it requires convincing customers of the problem's existence and demonstrating significant differences from existing solutions. It's advisable only when existing categories do not adequately showcase your unique strengths or when you possess enough resources to educate and influence the market effectively.

8.Question

How did Wattpad successfully position itself as an entertainment company?

Answer:Wattpad recognized that its platform held value beyond just writing; by analyzing audience engagement and

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leveraging insights, they positioned themselves to adapt stories for TV and film, transforming from a mere content platform to a full-fledged entertainment company.

9.Question

What lessons can be drawn from the positioning story of Janna Systems in the CRM market?

Answer:The key lesson is recognizing your unique differentiators and targeting them to a specific niche effectively, rather than trying to compete broadly against established leaders. Uplifting a niche position can lead to substantial success, particularly if you adapt messaging and product capabilities to meet the distinct needs of that niche.

10.Question

Why is timing significant when creating a new market category?

Answer:Timing is significant because it helps to address the question of 'Why now?' A successful category creation often coincides with shifts in technology, customer preferences, or regulatory changes, making it essential for businesses to

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present their solutions as timely and necessary.

11.Question

What role does educating the market play in the 'Create a New Game' strategy?

Answer:Educating the market is critical, as it lays the groundwork for why a new category is essential. This involves not just explaining the problem, but also guiding customers through evaluating solutions within that category and demonstrating why your solution stands out as the optimal choice.

Chapter 11 | Step 9. Layer On a Trend (but Be Careful)| Q&A

1.Question

What is the purpose of layering a trend on top of your positioning?

Answer:Layering a trend helps potential customers understand the importance of your offering in the current market context, making it look more relevant and attractive. It aligns your product's strengths with a current trend that resonates with

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your customer base.

2.Question

Can a product be successful without relating to a trend?

Answer:Yes, a well-positioned product can succeed even in the absence of a relevant trend. Success is possible through strong value propositions and effective market positioning alone, without the need for trendy associations.

3.Question

What caution should be taken when incorporating trends into your positioning?

Answer:Ensure that the trend you choose reinforces your positioning rather than muddling it. Misalignment can confuse customers, making your offerings seem less coherent.

4.Question

Give an example of a company that successfully incorporated trends into its positioning.

Answer:Redgate Software identified the rising trend of DevOps and connected it to their database products by creating content on 'database DevOps.' This strategic

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alignment led to a significant increase in sales and leads, demonstrating how trends can enhance product appeal when used appropriately.

5.Question

What are the dangers of focusing too much on trends?

Answer:Focusing excessively on trends can lead to customer confusion if the market context is overlooked. For example, businesses may describe themselves using trendy terms without first establishing a clear market identity, leading to misunderstandings about their actual offerings.

6.Question

What happened to Long Island Iced Tea when it rebranded as Long Blockchain?

Answer:The drastic name change generated initial investor excitement, but once it became clear there was no substantial link between the business model and blockchain technology, their stock value plummeted, resulting in their delisting from the Nasdaq.

7.Question

How can businesses thrive without trends?

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Answer:Businesses can succeed by relying on traditional positioning strategies and delivering consistent value, even if their market lacks current trends. Stability and reliability can be as appealing as trendiness.

8.Question

What does Wayne Dyer's quote, 'If you change the way you look at things, the things you look at change,' imply about business strategy?

Answer:It suggests that a shift in perspective can transform the business approach; reinterpreting your product and market context can lead to new opportunities for engagement and growth.

9.Question

What is a sign that a product is perceived as urgent or strategic after aligning with a trend?

Answer:A clear indicator is a significant increase in customer inquiries and multi-product purchases, as seen with Redgate Software after they adapted their messaging to incorporate industry trends.

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Chapter 12 | Step 10. Capture Your Positioning so It Can Be Shared| Q&A

1.Question

Why is capturing positioning important for a company?

Answer:Capturing positioning is crucial because it ensures that everyone in the organization understands the product's unique value and strategy. When positioning is shared broadly, it informs key areas like branding, marketing, sales, and product development. This alignment is essential for consistent messaging and successful execution across different teams.

2.Question

What should a positioning document include?

Answer:A positioning document should include detailed breakdowns of each component of the positioning strategy. This includes the product name, one-line description, market category, competitive alternatives, unique attributes, the value these attributes offer, and the target customer segments. The goal is to provide enough detail for effective

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understanding and application across various departments.

3.Question

How can positioning be effectively shared within a company?

Answer:Positioning can be effectively shared through the creation of a concise, one-page summary as well as a comprehensive positioning canvas. This canvas visually represents the relationship between different components of positioning, making it easier for all team members to grasp and utilize the strategy consistently in their roles.

4.Question

What elements are included in a positioning canvas?

Answer:A positioning canvas typically includes the product name and a one-line description, the market category and subcategory, competitive alternatives, unique attributes that set the product apart, the value those attributes provide to customers, and a profile of customer segments that are particularly invested in the value offered.

5.Question

How does effective positioning influence marketing and

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sales strategy?

Answer:Effective positioning provides a clear understanding of what makes the product unique and valuable, thus guiding the messaging used in marketing campaigns. It enables the sales team to better articulate the product's advantages to potential customers and to differentiate from competitors, ultimately leading to more effective sales strategies.

6.Question

What challenges might arise when trying to communicate positioning within a company?

Answer:Challenges may include difficulties in simplifying complex positioning into clear, easily understandable terms. Positioning statements can sometimes be too vague or overly intricate, making them hard to memorize or communicate by staff. Ensuring that all departments are aligned and utilize the positioning consistently can also be a significant challenge.

7.Question

Why is it important to understand competitive alternatives in positioning?

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Answer:Understanding competitive alternatives is important because it allows a company to identify what solutions customers currently use and to position their product as the better choice. This knowledge helps highlight unique attributes and create value propositions that resonate with target customers, enhancing the likelihood of adoption.

8.Question

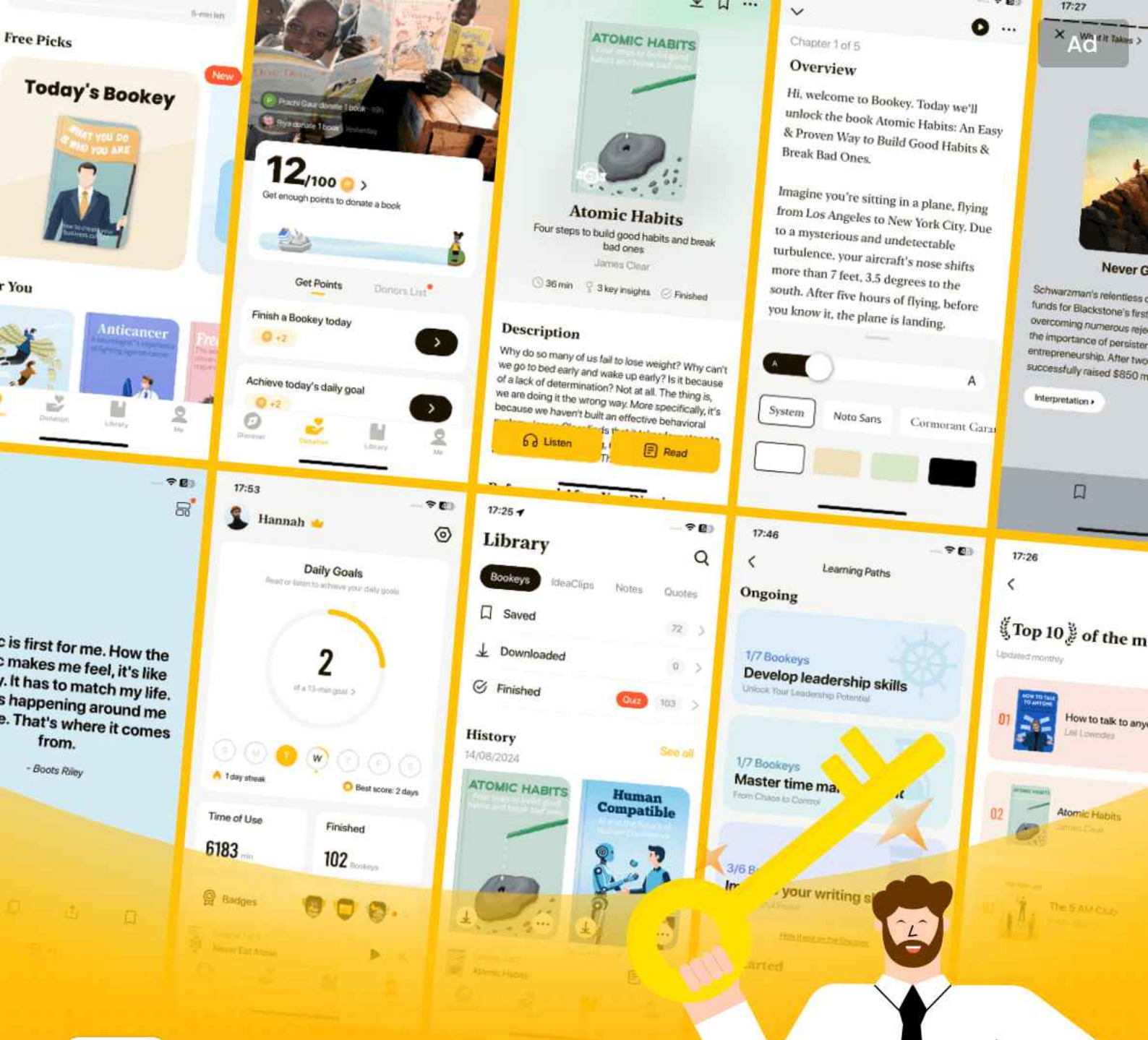
What makes a customer 'care a lot' about the value delivered?

Answer:A customer 'cares a lot' when their needs, challenges, or aspirations align closely with the value the product provides. Specific characteristics such as their pain points, goals, or demographic traits can significantly influence how much they value the unique benefits of the product, making it essential to clearly define these in positioning.

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Chapter 13 | After Positioning: What Happens Next?| Q&A

1.Question

What should companies do immediately after completing a positioning exercise?

Answer:After completing a positioning exercise, companies should create new messaging that reflects their positioning. However, it's more effective to first craft a 'sales story' that outlines how salespeople can pitch the product based on the new positioning.

2.Question

Why is crafting a sales story important for businesses selling to other businesses?

Answer:Crafting a sales story is important because it helps salespeople define the problem that their product solves, identify shortcomings of current solutions, and articulate the 'perfect world' scenario that their product addresses. This unified narrative equips sales staff with a clear and compelling way to present the product.

3.Question

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What are the key components of a sales story?

Answer:A sales story typically includes: 1) Definition of the problem solved; 2) Description of how customers currently try to solve this problem and where current solutions fail; 3) A vision of a perfect solution; 4) Introducing the product and its market category; 5) Detailed discussion of the value themes; and 6) Next steps for the prospect.

4.Question

How can messaging impact a company's positioning over time?

Answer:Messaging is crucial as it communicates the company's value proposition. A lack of a master messaging document can lead to inconsistencies that could drift the company’s positioning, whereas a solid messaging strategy helps maintain coherent and aligned communication across all channels.

5.Question

What happens to a company’s product roadmap after changing its positioning?

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Answer:When a company changes its positioning, it often affects its product roadmap by shifting how features are prioritized. The new positioning may anchor the company in a different market category, thus guiding future developments to align with new customer expectations and requirements.

6.Question

Why is it important for a company to check in on its positioning regularly?

Answer:Companies should regularly check in on their positioning because both markets and products change over time. Regular reassessments, ideally every six months, help ensure the company's positioning remains relevant amidst shifts due to competitive landscapes, regulatory changes, and customer preferences.

7.Question

What external changes could necessitate a shift in a company’s positioning?

Answer:External changes that could necessitate a shift in

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positioning include: 1) New competitors entering the market, 2) Changes in government regulations, 3) Major economic shifts or downturns, 4) Advancements in technology altering customer expectations, and 5) Evolving customer attitudes and preferences.

8.Question

How can a company ensure its positioning remains strong in a competitive landscape?

Answer:A company can ensure strong positioning by staying vigilant about market changes, customer perceptions, and competitor moves. It’s important to be adaptive and responsive, ensuring that the value propositions aligned with customer expectations and market realities.

9.Question

What unique insights emerged from the author’s previous experience in the tech industry?

Answer:The author noticed that customer preferences can shift unexpectedly; for example, buyers may develop an appreciation for aesthetics, such as a product’s design, which

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may influence their purchasing decisions, even if they were previously overlooked. This highlights the need for companies to be attentive to evolving customer attitudes.

10.Question

What is the ultimate goal of communicating a strong positioning internally within a company?

Answer:The ultimate goal of communicating strong positioning internally is to create a unified understanding among all team members about the differentiated value of the offering, ensuring alignment in messaging, sales approaches, and overall company strategy.

Chapter 14 | Conclusion| Q&A

1.Question

What is the main insight about product positioning that you learned from your early career?

Answer:Initially, I believed product positioning was largely out of my control, influenced by buyer behavior, market unpredictability, and luck. Over time, I discovered I could significantly influence

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positioning by understanding market patterns and refining my skills.

2.Question

How does deliberate practice influence successful product positioning?

Answer:Deliberate practice allows you to experiment, learn from failures, test your ideas, and refine your approach, leading to improved product positioning.

3.Question

What key takeaway can be drawn about markets and product positioning?

Answer:Any product can be positioned in multiple markets, meaning you're not limited to struggling in a market where your product's value is not understood.

4.Question

Why is understanding customer perception of alternatives important?

Answer:Understanding what your best customers view as legitimate alternatives helps you identify your differentiators, allowing you to better position your product against

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competition.

5.Question

What caution should be exercised when using market trends in product positioning?

Answer:You should be careful not to adopt trends merely for the sake of being trendy; prefer foundational strengths over fleeting fashions to maintain clarity and customer trust.

6.Question

What is a critical barrier to effective leadership in marketing according to the book?

Answer:Leaders often excel at doing tasks but struggle to articulate and teach those skills to their teams, making knowledge sharing difficult.

7.Question

How does April Dunford aim to support organizations with her workshops?

Answer:April provides structured workshops tailored to various needs, helping teams understand their product positioning and develop compelling sales narratives.

8.Question

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What can participants expect from April Dunford's two-day workshop?

Answer:Participants will gain a framework for comprehending how customers perceive products and develop a clear positioning strategy that highlights their product's value.

9.Question

How does April Dunford address the unique needs of early-stage startups?

Answer:She conducts engaging workshops specifically aimed at early-stage startups, focusing on practical positioning knowledge, case studies, and foundational marketing principles.

10.Question

What feedback is shared about April Dunford's expertise?

Answer:Clients note her ability to simplify complex market strategy challenges and provide actionable solutions, highlighting her extensive experience and insight.

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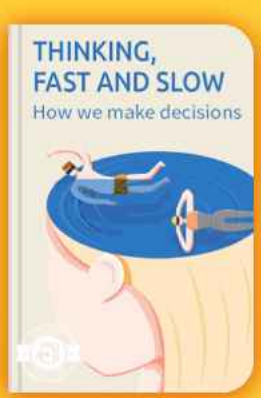
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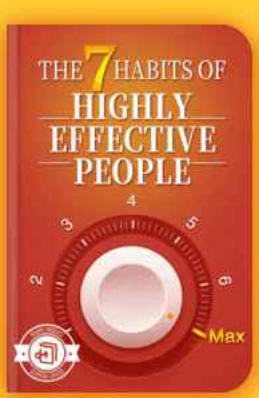
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Chapter 1 | Positioning as Context| Quiz and Test

1. Positioning a product is similar to setting the context in a movie's opening scene, which helps the audience understand key elements.
2. Joshua Bell's experience illustrates that even the best musicians are always recognized regardless of context.
3. Effective positioning can transform ordinary products into exceptional ones and significantly influence market perception.

Chapter 2 | The Five (plus One) Components of Effective Positioning| Quiz and Test

1. Traditional positioning statements are effective tools for discerning market advantages.
2. Identifying competitive alternatives is an important component of effective positioning.
3. The five components of effective positioning do not include market category.

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Chapter 3 | Step 1. Understand the Customers Who Love Your Product| Quiz and Test

1. Understanding the interdependencies within the components of positioning is vital for defining the best market category.
2. Focusing primarily on product features is the most effective strategy for positioning a product in the market.
3. Each product in a multi-product company should have its own positioning that aligns with the company's overall brand.

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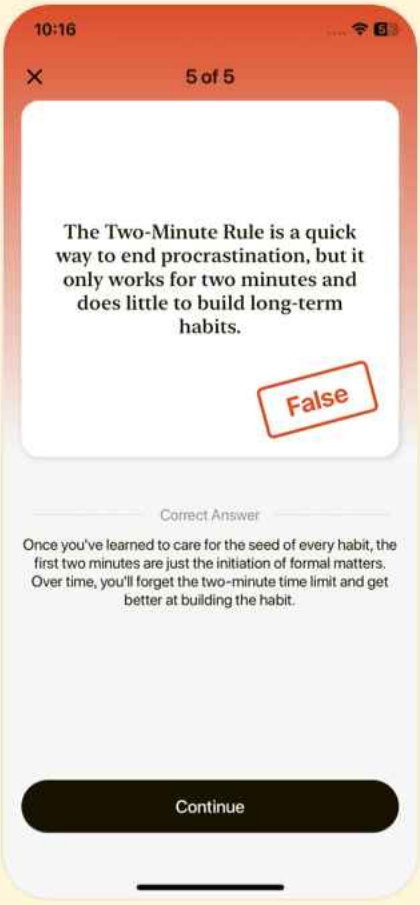
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Chapter 4 | Step 2. Form a Positioning Team| Quiz and Test

1. A successful positioning process requires teamwork solely from the marketing department.
2. The CEO or founders typically lead the positioning effort in startups.
3. It's beneficial to have every employee in the organization participate in the positioning discussion.

Chapter 5 | Step 3. Align Your Positioning Vocabulary and Let Go of Your Positioning Baggage| Quiz and Test

1. Positioning vocabulary and understanding its components are important for a team to work effectively on product positioning.
2. Letting go of positioning baggage means that a team should hold onto their historical perspectives when defining a product's market position.
3. Clearpath Robotics was initially perceived as a provider of simple robots but successfully repositioned as a developer of autonomous vehicles for industrial applications.

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Chapter 6 | Step 4. List Your True Competitive Alternatives| Quiz and Test

1. Customers always view competitors the same way businesses do.
2. Understanding the problems customers aim to solve is essential for positioning a product.
3. Companies should include all competitors, regardless of their market presence, in their analysis of competitive alternatives.

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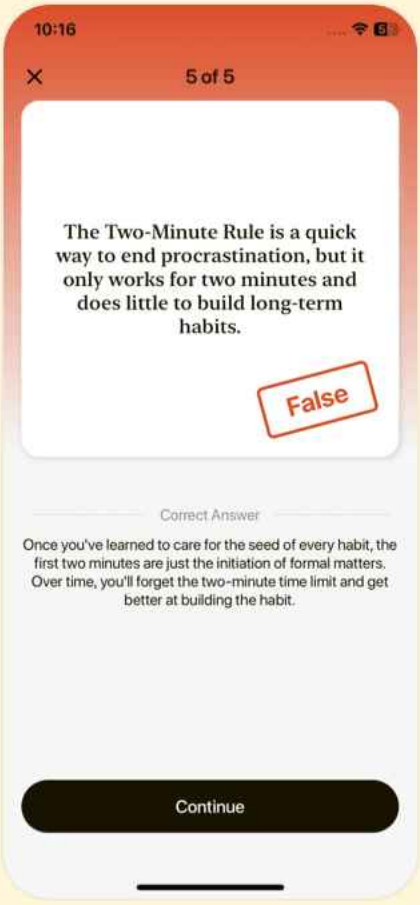
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Chapter 7 | Step 5. Isolate Your Unique Attributes or Features| Quiz and Test

1. Strong positioning revolves around the strengths of a product.
2. Focus on 'retention' attributes, which are only important during renewal, when defining your unique attributes.
3. Independent reviewers and customer testimonials can enhance claims about your product's features versus competitors.

Chapter 8 | Step 6. Map the Attributes to Value “Themes”| Quiz and Test

1. Features are the same as benefits in product marketing.
2. Every feature has the potential to create multiple value points for customers.
3. To effectively communicate product value, technical details should not be coupled with benefits and their resultant value.

Chapter 9 | Step 7. Determine Who Cares a Lot| Quiz and Test

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1. Identifying the value of your product is sufficient for marketers to know which customers to target.
2. Narrowing your target market helps optimize your marketing resources and improves sales effectiveness.
3. Traditional demographic-based segmentation is always the best approach for targeting customers in a business context.

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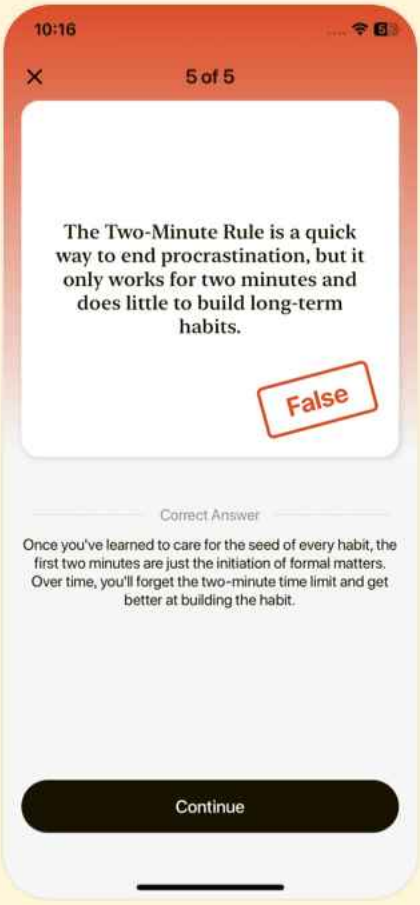
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Chapter 10 | Step 8. Find a Market Frame of Reference That Puts Your Strengths at the Center and Determine How to Position in It| Quiz and Test

1. A market frame of reference must align with existing customer perceptions and should not be a newly defined category unless intentionally crafted.
2. Positioning your product within a market does not help customers understand what to compare it against.
3. Creating a new market category requires significantly less effort than competing in an existing one.

Chapter 11 | Step 9. Layer On a Trend (but Be Careful)| Quiz and Test

1. Layering a trend on your positioning can improve customer understanding of your offering's relevance.
2. It is advisable to integrate any trend into your product positioning strategy without concern for alignment.
3. Redgate Software successfully aligned their products with the trend of DevOps to change customer perceptions.

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Chapter 12 | Step 10. Capture Your Positioning so It Can Be Shared| Quiz and Test

1. Positioning needs to be shared throughout the organization for successful implementation in branding, marketing, and sales.
2. Positioning statements are always brief and effectively capture all product nuances.
3. A positioning canvas is not helpful for visualizing the critical components of positioning communication.

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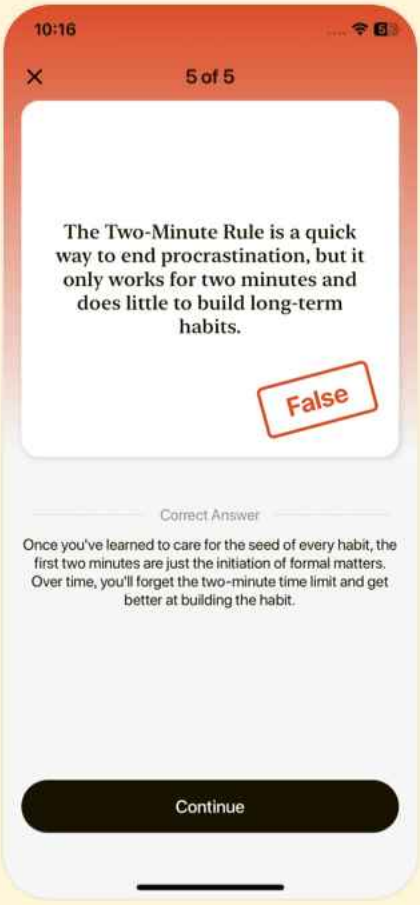
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Chapter 13 | After Positioning: What Happens Next?| Quiz and Test

1. A sales story is crucial for businesses with complex sales cycles.
2. The components of a sales story do not include a clear outline of the problem being addressed by the solution.
3. Positioning should be viewed as a static marketing element that does not require regular reassessment.

Chapter 14 | Conclusion| Quiz and Test

1. Products can only be positioned in one market.
2. Effective positioning is random and requires no practice.
3. Recognizing competitors is important to identify your differentiators.

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